

Strings

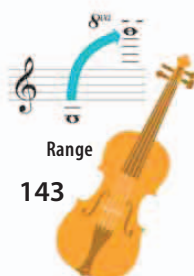
The “twang” of a huntsman’s bow thousands of years ago inspired the development of a stringed instrument. A simple harp evolved with more strings and a resonating box. By adding a bow to sound the strings, the forerunners of modern orchestral strings were born.

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Orchestral strings

Violins, violas, violoncellos (usually called cellos), and double basses are the backbone of classical music. When played together, they blend particularly pleasingly because they all make their sound in the same way. They all have similar body shapes and four strings, which are normally played with a bow, but which may also be plucked.



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△ Violin

Violins play the highest notes in the orchestral string family. They are divided into two groups known as firsts and seconds.



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△ Viola

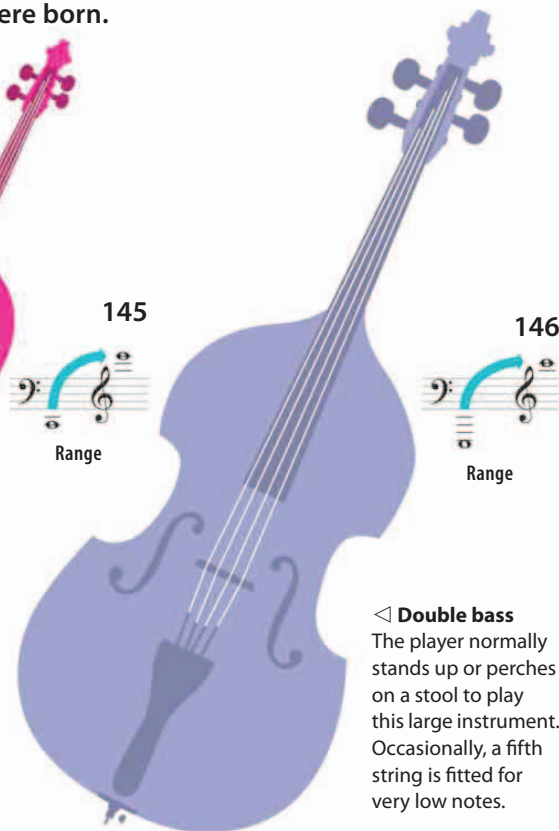
The viola has a larger body and longer strings than the violin, giving its deeper notes a distinctively rich, dark quality.



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△ Violoncello

The cello body is supported on a spike on the floor. Its beautiful tone quality makes it a favorite for soloists as well as for orchestra members.



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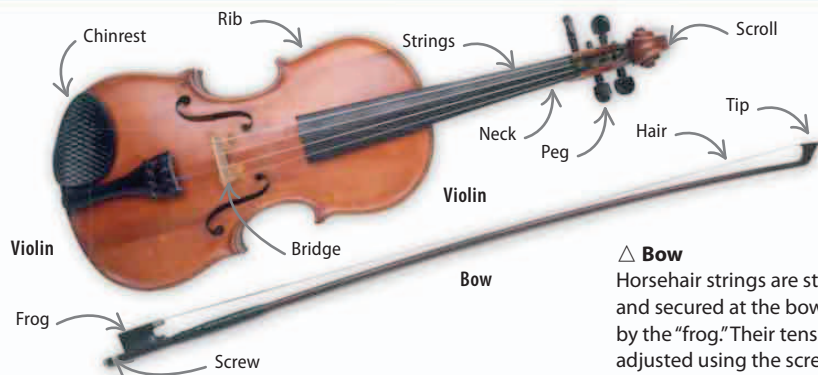
◁ Double bass

The player normally stands up or perches on a stool to play this large instrument. Occasionally, a fifth string is fitted for very low notes.

REAL WORLD

Violin

The vibrations of the violin strings are transmitted to its wooden body through the bridge—a narrow piece of wood over which the strings pass. Strings are tuned by adjusting the pegs at the scroll.



△ Bow

Horsehair strings are stretched and secured at the bow's heel by the “frog.” Their tension is adjusted using the screw.